

RNN (Recurrent Neural Network)

- Basics and understanding -

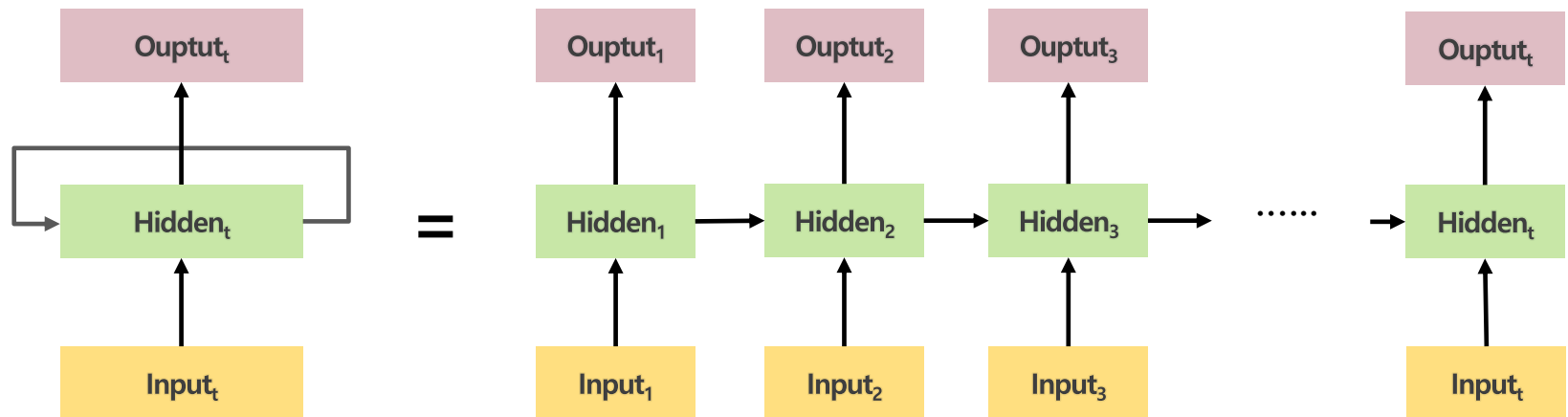
Fall 2025

School of IT Convergence

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Review - RNN

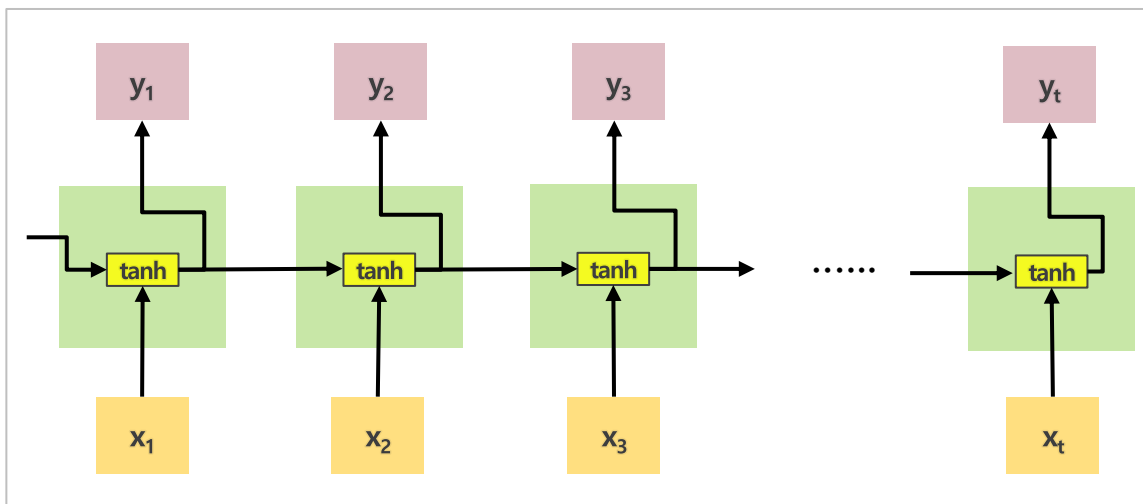
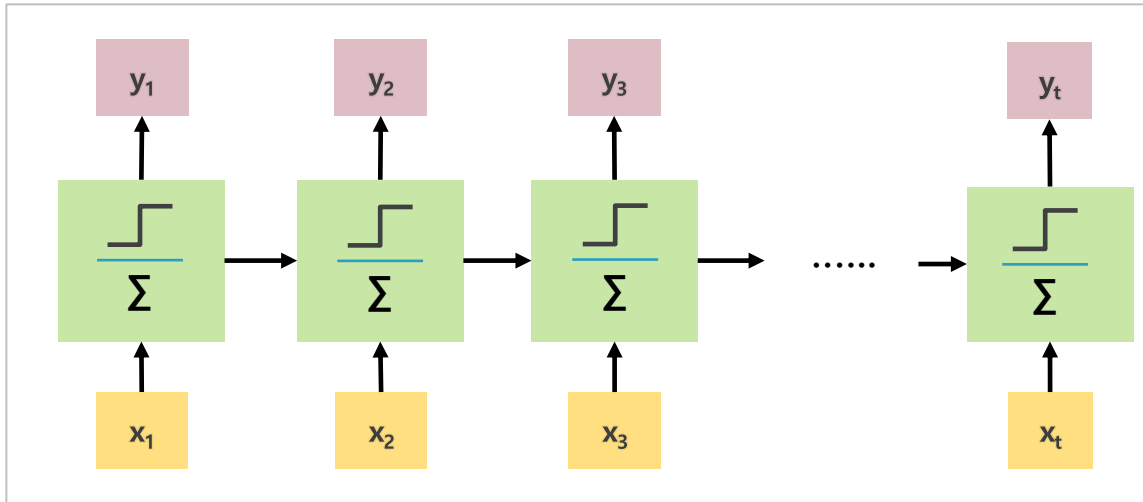
- RNN (Recurrent Neural Network)
 - Train [sequential data](#) or [time series data](#)
 - Create the current hidden vector from the previous hidden vector (t-1) and current input vector (t)



N:N RNN structure

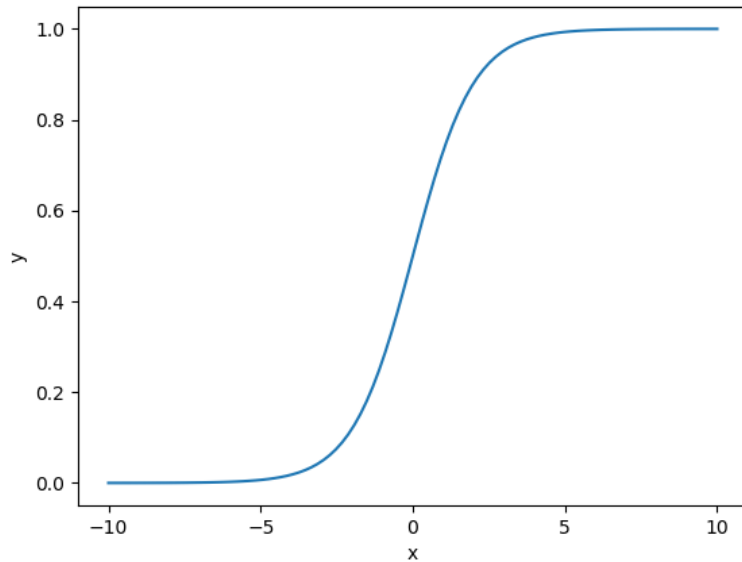
RNN (1)

- RNN's structure



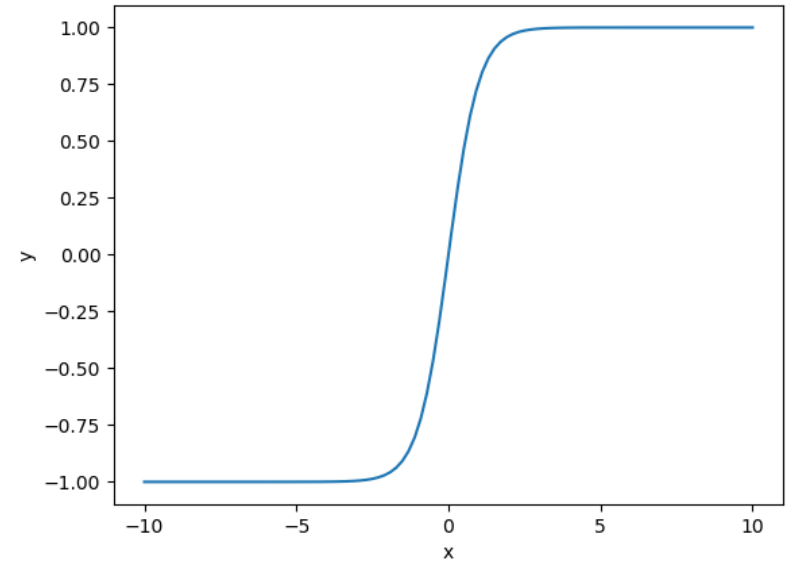
RNN (2)

- Activation functions (Sigmoid vs Tanh)



$$S(x) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-x}} = \frac{e^x}{e^x + 1} = 1 - S(-x)$$

Sigmoid



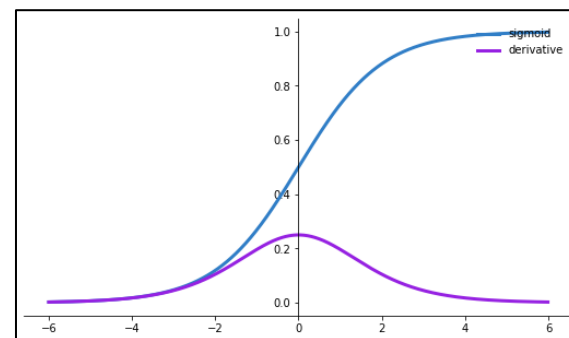
$$\tanh(x) = \frac{e^x - e^{-x}}{e^x + e^{-x}}$$

Tanh

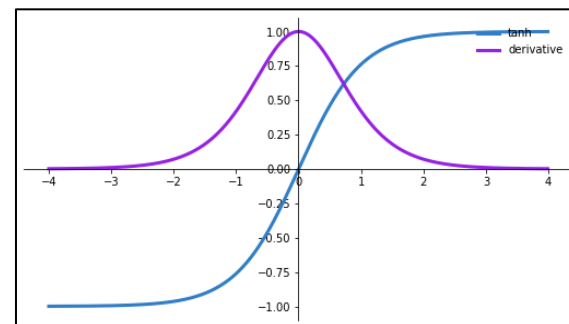
RNN (3)

- Typical activation functions and their derivatives

Name	Plot	Equation	Derivative
Identity		$f(x) = x$	$f'(x) = 1$
Binary step		$f(x) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{for } x < 0 \\ 1 & \text{for } x \geq 0 \end{cases}$	$f'(x) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{for } x \neq 0 \\ ? & \text{for } x = 0 \end{cases}$
Logistic (a.k.a Soft step)		$f(x) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-x}}$	$f'(x) = f(x)(1 - f(x))$
Tanh		$f(x) = \tanh(x) = \frac{2}{1 + e^{-2x}} - 1$	$f'(x) = 1 - f(x)^2$
ArcTan		$f(x) = \tan^{-1}(x)$	$f'(x) = \frac{1}{x^2 + 1}$
Rectified Linear Unit (ReLU)		$f(x) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{for } x < 0 \\ x & \text{for } x \geq 0 \end{cases}$	$f'(x) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{for } x < 0 \\ 1 & \text{for } x \geq 0 \end{cases}$
Parameteric Rectified Linear Unit (PReLU) [2]		$f(x) = \begin{cases} \alpha x & \text{for } x < 0 \\ x & \text{for } x \geq 0 \end{cases}$	$f'(x) = \begin{cases} \alpha & \text{for } x < 0 \\ 1 & \text{for } x \geq 0 \end{cases}$
Exponential Linear Unit (ELU) [3]		$f(x) = \begin{cases} \alpha(e^x - 1) & \text{for } x < 0 \\ x & \text{for } x \geq 0 \end{cases}$	$f'(x) = \begin{cases} f(x) + \alpha & \text{for } x < 0 \\ 1 & \text{for } x \geq 0 \end{cases}$
SoftPlus		$f(x) = \log_e(1 + e^x)$	$f'(x) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-x}}$



Sigmoid and its derivative

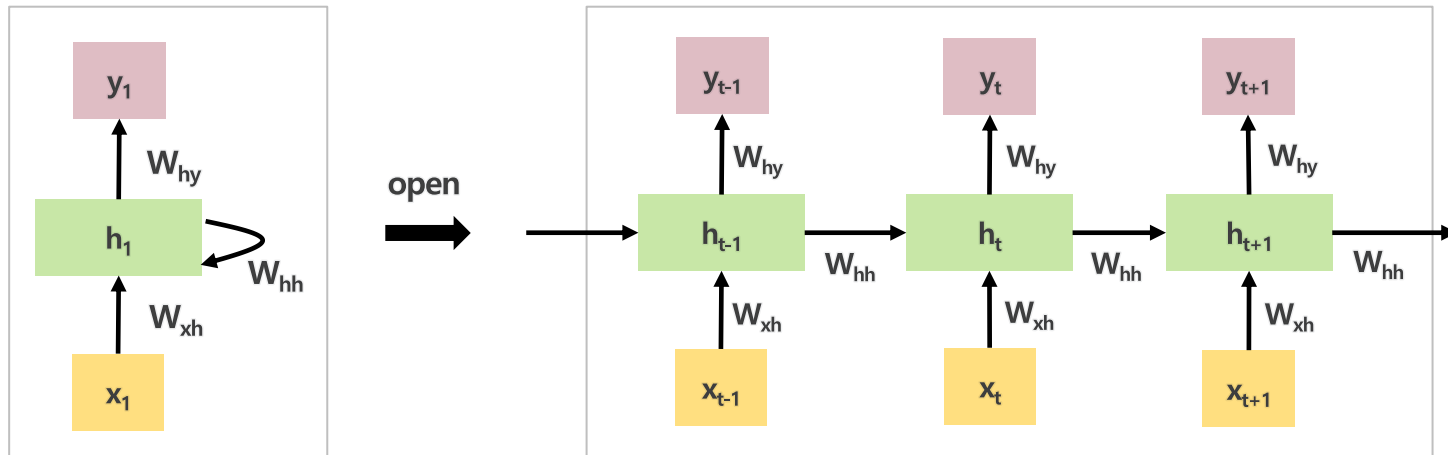


Tanh and its derivative

RNN (4)

- RNN's structure

- W_{xh} : weights transferred from the input layer to the hidden layer
- W_{hh} : weights transferred from the hidden layer at time t to the hidden layer at time $t+1$
- W_{hy} : weights transferred from the hidden layer to the output layer



RNN (5)

- RNN's structure

1. Hidden layer

- Hyperbolic tangent function

$$W_{xh} = \tanh(h_t)$$

$$h_t = W_{hh} * h_{t-1} + W_{xh} * x_t$$

No bias case !!

2. Output layer

- Softmax function

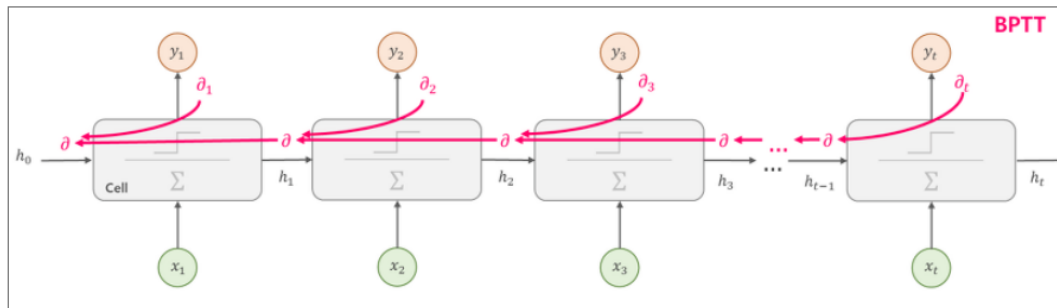
$$y_t = \text{softmax}(W_{hy} * h_t)$$

3. Error

- Error between real-value and predicted value for each step

4. BPTT (Back-propagation through time)

- Measure errors at each step and pass it to the previous step
- Update weights W_{xh} , W_{hh} , W_{hy}

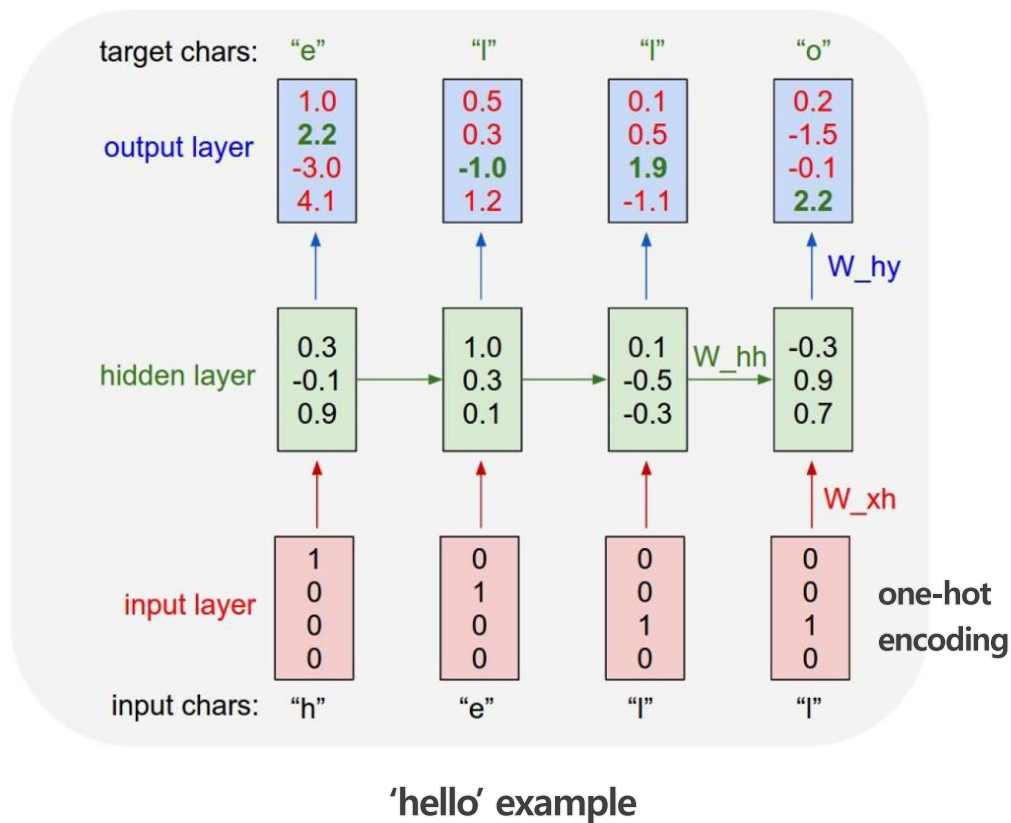
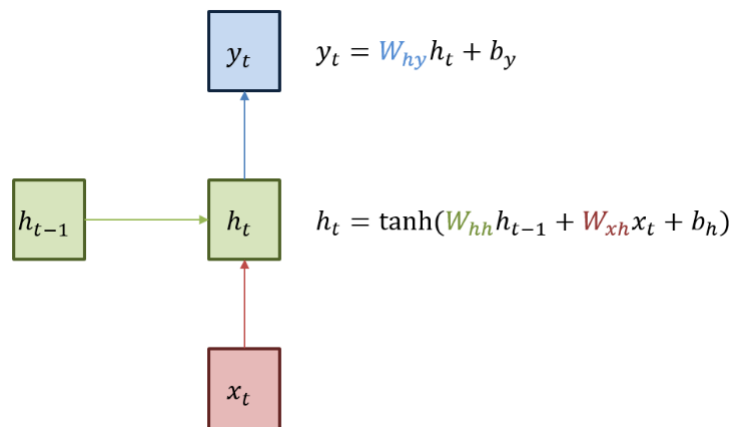


Vanishing gradient problem

→ Truncated BPTT

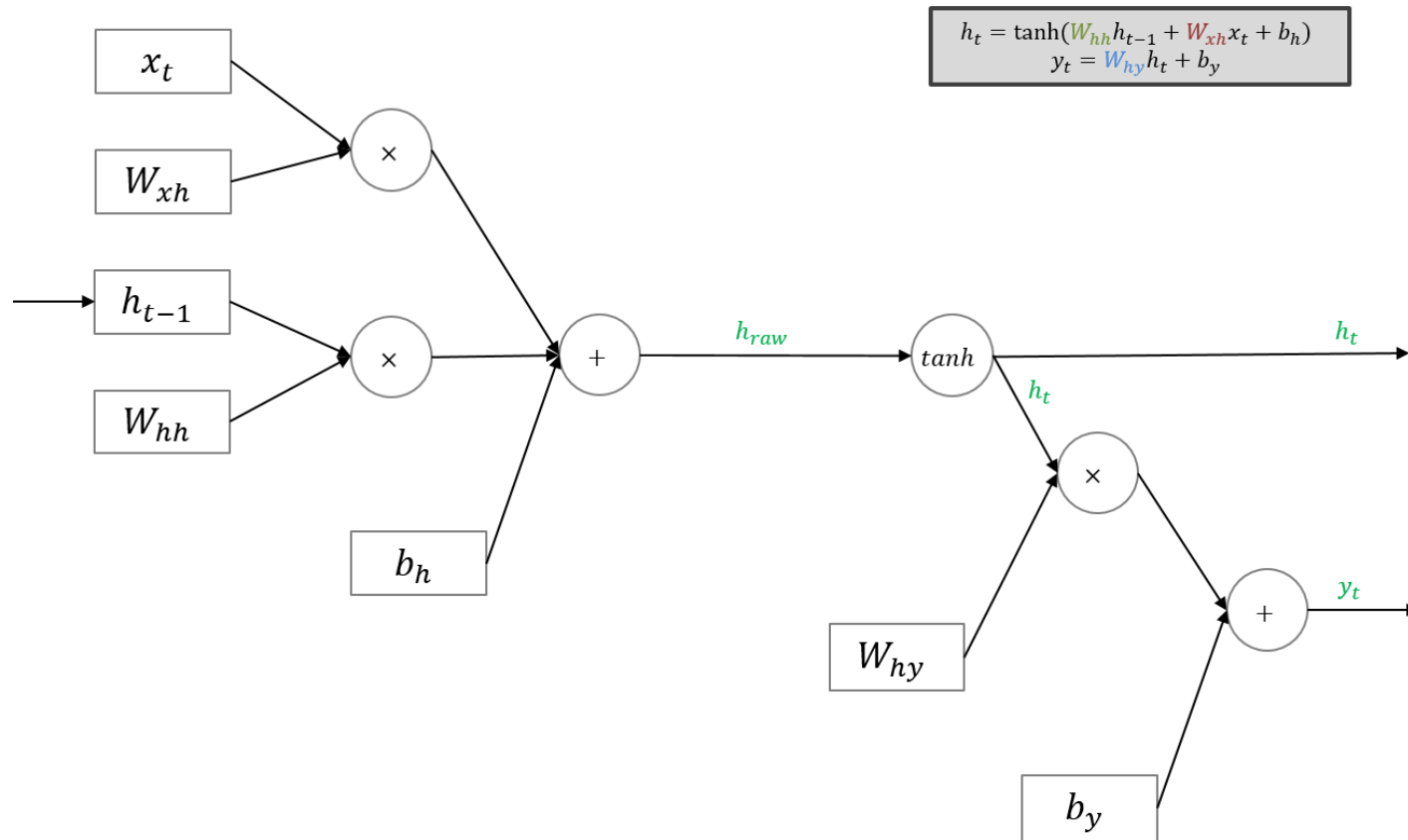
RNN (6)

- RNN's structure



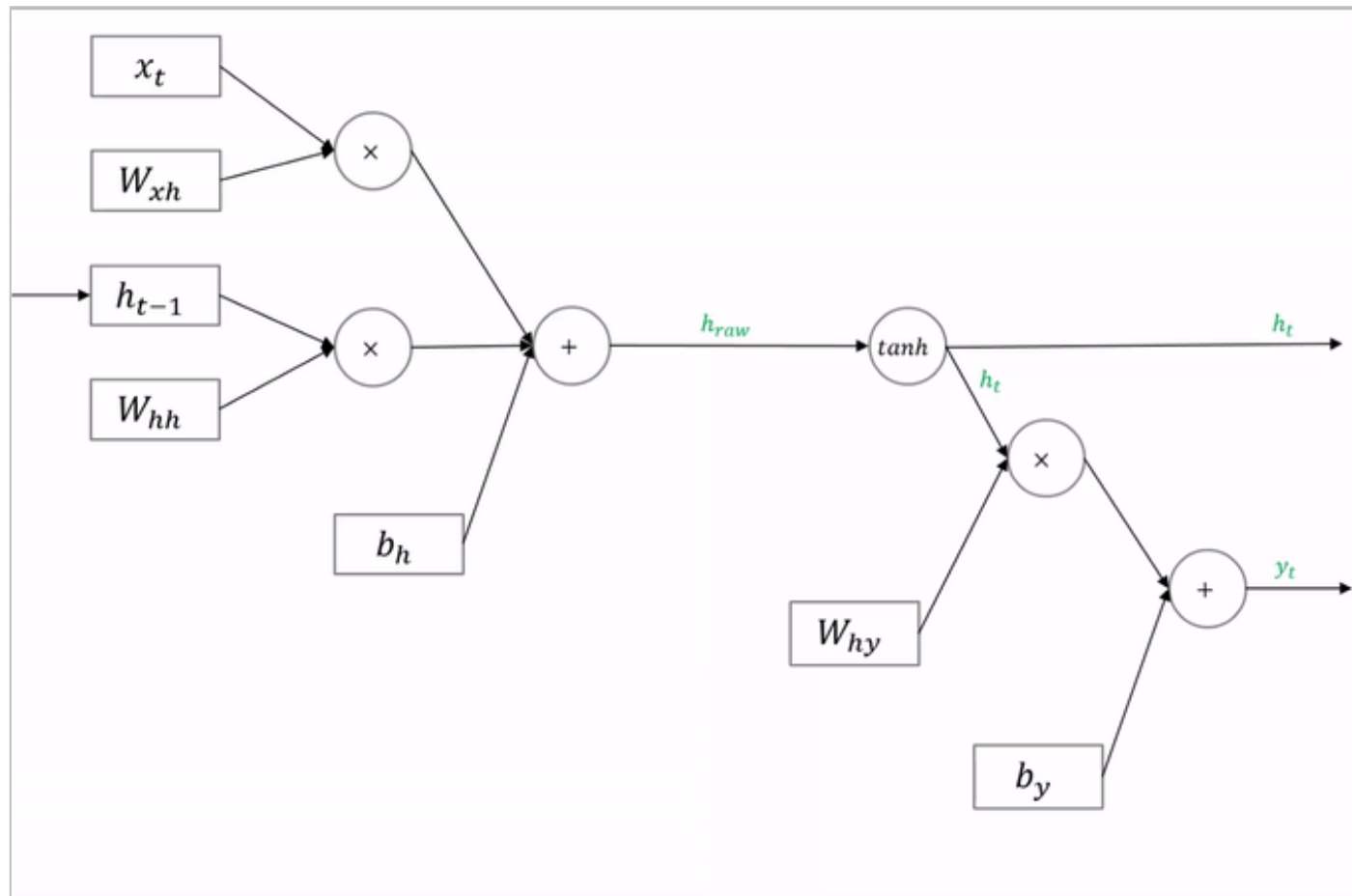
RNN (7)

- RNN propagation



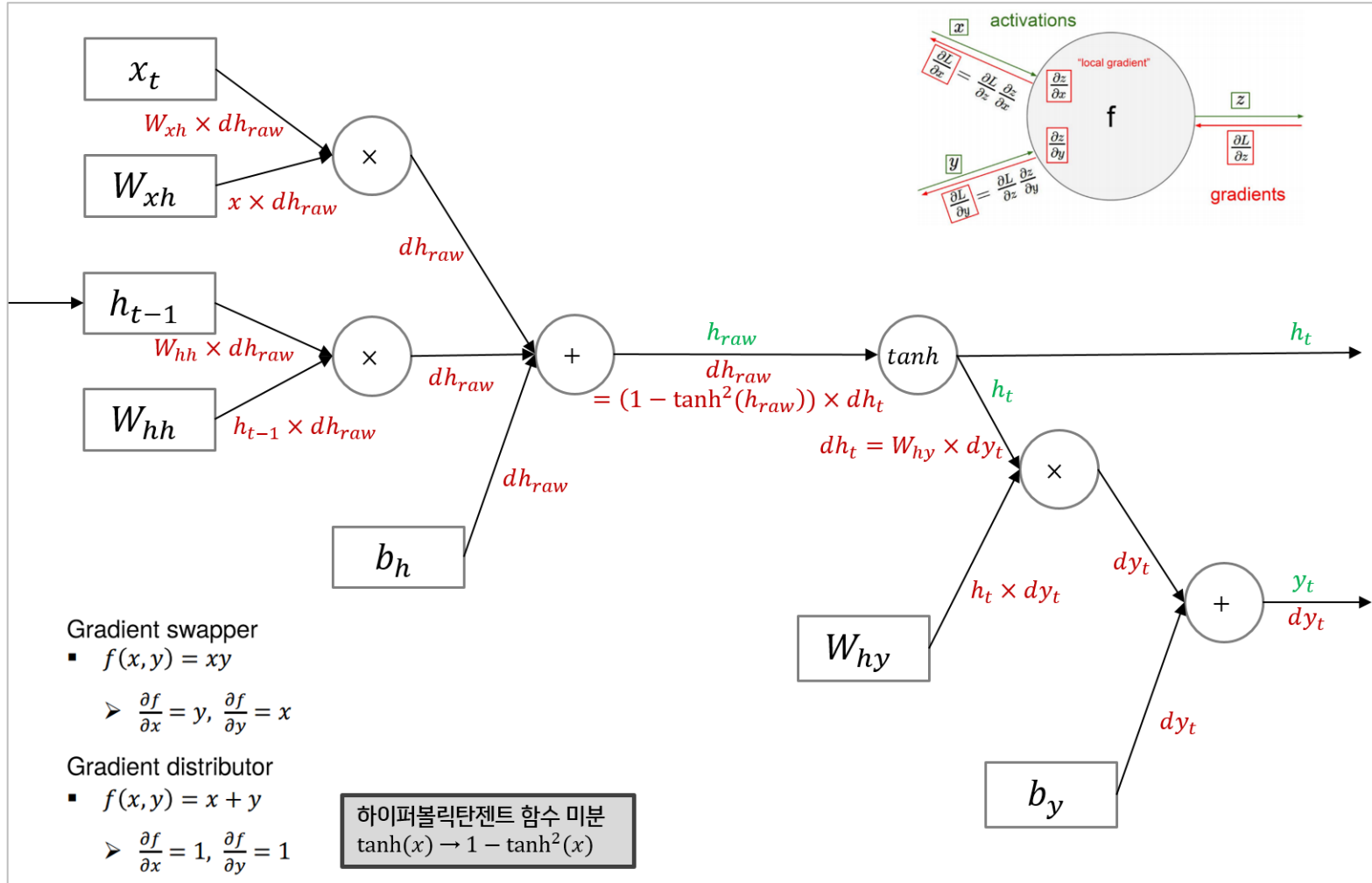
RNN (7)

- RNN back-propagation



RNN (8)

- RNN back-propagation



Q & A
